

Brenner 1985 as Methodological Hinge, Not Epistemic Rupture

A verdict on the focal article's oeuvre position — what it culminates, what it seeds, and why neither label is rupture

07 September 2026 · researcher edition · medium depth · 58 source documents · job dossier-desks-run1b

The 1985 article 'Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism' occupies a specific and arguable position in Brenner's oeuvre: it is neither the origin of his class-relational causal ontology nor a simple restatement of it, but the text in which an already-established research programme becomes explicitly self-conscious about its Marxological alternatives. The body supports this verdict by separating two dimensions — substantive causal commitments and argumentative form — and showing that they fall on opposite sides of the 1985 boundary. The four core causal propositions (commercial opportunities have socially variable effects; property and class relations are antecedent to and mediating of market and demographic pressures; capitalist compulsion derives from market dependence, not exchange alone; transition requires a specified account of class formation beyond the rise of trade) are each traceable to texts from 1972 through 1978, making the focal article a culmination in the strict sense: it explains the necessity of commitments that were already doing causal work. What the focal article adds is architectural and formal, not substantive: it converts those dispersed polemical and comparative commitments into an internal genealogy of two incompatible historical materialisms within Marx, locating the error of the 'Smithian' first model inside early Marx rather than only in twentieth-century neo-Smithian variants such as Wallerstein and Sweezy. That move is methodologically new — and constitutes a genuine reorientation — but it does not alter what the oeuvre claims about how history works.

From the focal text forward, the body identifies an asymmetric seeding pattern. The portable causal grammar — property relations structure rules of reproduction, which aggregate into developmental outcomes that defeat actors' intentions — travels across every major subsequent domain: the 1986 Social Basis essay formalizes it as an explicit causal chain; the 2001 Low Countries essay converts the focal text's prisoners-dilemma formulation of the transition problem into a positive historical proposition about unintended consequences; the 1998 Economics of Global Turbulence transfers the same prisoners-dilemma grammar to inter-firm competition and capitalist crisis. What does not travel is the detailed Marxological apparatus of the focal text itself — the individuation genealogy, the family-atomism account, the craft–manufacture–machinofac-

ture stage sequence — all of which are absent from every post-1985 text in the supplied corpus. The focal text thus seeds its grammar and drops its scaffolding. Two real changes that might look like post-1985 ruptures are registered but located at the wrong boundary: the shift in immediate crisis driver from class struggle to inter-capitalist competition belongs to the 1998 text, not 1985; the emergence of political-capitalism concepts belongs to 2022–25. Neither is attributable to the focal boundary.

Three methodological qualifications constrain the verdict throughout. First, the focal article declares itself Part I of a longer work; no identifiable Part II is present in the supplied corpus, leaving the positive reconstruction of Marx's second model as a programmatic sketch rather than a completed argument, which means the focal text's contribution is assessed on an incomplete specimen. Second, the focal text, the 1985 Agrarian Roots essay, and the 1986 Social Basis essay share overlapping arguments in a narrow publication window, so their composition sequence — and therefore which seeded which — cannot be determined from publication dates alone. Third, two bodies of work cited in later profiles (the 1978 'Dobb on the Transition' essay and the 1996–97 transition studies) are absent from the supplied collection; if those texts already deploy 'rules for reproduction' or formulate the unintended-consequences mechanism, the dating of certain conceptual innovations attributed here to the focal text or to 1986 would need to be moved earlier. The defensible periodization — formation 1972–84, codification and extension 1985–2025, the focal text as methodological hinge — stands on the available evidence, but it stands provisionally and against specific falsifiable conditions.

1 Two Incompatible Historical Materialisms: The Focal Text's Central Claim

Brenner's 1985 article does not argue that Marxists have underestimated class struggle, or that trade is insufficient — both propositions are already on record by 1977. Its distinctive contribution is formal: it divides Marx's transition theory into two historical materialisms and shows that one of them is structurally circular. The division itself is the innovation, not the verdict it produces.

The first model, tracing from the German Ideology through the Communist Manifesto, makes productive forces and the division of labour generate the class and property forms appropriate to each historical stage. The second, emerging from the Grundrisse and Capital, reverses that priority.¹ Here property relations are antecedent — they organize how actors reproduce themselves — and the question of transition becomes the question of how those prior relations are themselves transformed.

The circularity charge is Brenner's sharpest move. He argues that the first model's progression from exchange and specialization to capitalist behavior works reliably only where producers already depend on competitive markets for their survival. But that is precisely the condition the model is supposed to

derive.² The first model, in other words, assumes the transition in order to explain it — a logical short-circuit that no amount of historical evidence can repair, because the error is architectural.

A companion consequence is that class struggle loses real causal weight inside the first model. Because stages follow from productive-force development, the outcomes of lord-peasant conflict cannot alter the sequence — they are predetermined by the logic that drives it.³ Struggle appears in the story, but as an expression of forces already at work, not as a shaping cause. That, for Brenner, is the diagnostic sign of the Smithian inheritance inside early Marx.

No exhibit illustrating the two-model architecture could be built from the available materials, so the reconstruction above relies entirely on the focal text's own argument. What is critical for the reader going forward is to recognize that this formal achievement — locating an incompatible second model inside Marx rather than merely asserting the insufficiency of trade — is what allows the focal text to be more than another entry in the Dobb–Sweezy controversy. It changes the argumentative field from a dispute between rival social theories to an internal genealogy of Marxian historical materialism, and it is that change which the next sections must date and evaluate.

2 What the Focal Text Cites, Carries, and Drops: The Bibliographic Signature of a Reorientation

The focal text's bibliography is concentrated in a way that marks an abrupt change of genre. Earlier Brenner essays — the 1976 agrarian class structure piece and the 1977 *Origins of Capitalist Development* — built their arguments against a wide empirical archive: Postan and Hilton on demographic cycles and serfdom, Wallerstein on world-system incorporation, Dobb and Sweezy on the mechanics of feudal decline, Pirenne on urban commerce and merchant succession. None of these appear in the 1985 article. The agrarian-historical and world-system literature is simply absent.

What replaces it is a Marxological cluster assembled from canonical texts: the *German Ideology* is the primary source for the early model,⁴ and the *Grundrisse* and *Pre-Capitalist Economic Formations* supply the positive contrast.⁵ Ronald Meek's study of the four-stages theory enters as the intellectual bridge between Smith and early Marx, positioning both within Enlightenment conjectural history. G. A. Cohen's functionalism enters as a contemporary attempt to do the same explanatory work the focal text is dismantling. These four — *German Ideology*, *Grundrisse*-based formations, Meek, Cohen — form a cluster found nowhere else in the supplied corpus at this density.

The carried citations — Marx, Smith, Capital, North and Thomas — change their argumentative role rather than simply reappearing. In 1977, Smith was the paradigm of exchange-led development that Brenner opposed from outside.⁶ In 1985, Smith is the genealogical source of early Marx's error: the first model 'mirrors rather closely' the account in the *Wealth of Nations*. Smith has become part of the object of analysis, not just a comparator. The same displacement happens to Wallerstein and Sweezy: they cease to be the focal text's primary opponents and are repositioned near the conclusion as Marxists

who 'follow the master' in adopting Smithian strategies. The polemical target is now internal to Marxism.

The article also carries one self-citation: Brenner's 1977 'Origins of Capitalism: A Critique of Neo-Smithian Marxism.' This is important. It marks the focal text as a continuation and deepening rather than a new beginning — the Marxological reconstruction is explicitly presented as building on an already-established anti-commercialization argument.

One bibliographic fact must be held firmly. The focal text declares itself incomplete:⁷ an announced sequel means that the full treatment of Marx's second model — the positive alternative Brenner prefers — was never supplied within this article. The corpus as assembled contains no identifiable 'Part II.' What the reader has is a detailed demolition of the first model and a programmatic sketch of the second. The next section asks what the first model's demolition inherits, and what the sketch of the second one seeds.

3 What the Focal Text Inherits: Culmination of the 1972–84 Transition Agenda

Table 1 below displays the four substantive commitments the focal text codifies, the pre-1985 texts that first established them, and the specific work the focal article does with each. Read across the rows, the table shows that none of the four causal propositions originates in 1985.

Table 1. Four substantive commitments inherited by the focal text and what it adds to each

COMMITMENT	FIRST ESTABLISHED IN (TEXT, YEAR)	ANCHOR IN PRE-FOCAL TEXT	WHAT THE FOCAL TEXT ADDS OR CHANGES	FINDING
Commercial opportunities have socially variable effects; market causation is not automatic	The Social Basis of English Commercial Expansion (1972)	"The reaction to commercial opportunity (or cost), if indeed there is one, will tend to vary with the social, political, and economic character of the mercantile group." ⁸	Generalises the anti-automatic principle from merchant behaviour to modes of production: exchange cannot transform property relations unless market dependence already exists ⁹	F1, R1.F1
Class/property relations mediate demographic and commercial pressures into divergent developmental outcomes	Agrarian Class Structure and Economic Development (1976)	"It is the structure of class relations, of class power, which will determine the manner and degree to which particular demographic and commercial changes will affect long-run trends in the distribution of income and economic growth — and not vice versa." ¹⁰	Recasts class/property relations as antecedent conditions of reproduction rather than effects of productive forces; supplies a general theoretical warrant for the 1976 finding ¹	F2, R1.F2, R2.F1
Capitalist compulsion derives from market dependence (separation from means of reproduction), not from exchange alone	The Origins of Capitalist Development (1977)	"Only where labour power is a commodity—and which was therefore called by Marx 'generalized commodity production'—is there the necessity of producing at the 'socially necessary' labour time in order to survive." ¹¹	Uses the distinction diagnostically to expose the first Marxian model's circularity: its developmental mechanism works regularly only 'in an established capitalist economy,' presupposing what it must explain ¹²	F3, R1.F3, R2.F2
Transition requires a specified account of class formation, class conflict, and primitive accumulation beyond the rise of trade	Reply to Sweezy (1978)	"Nor did Sweezy specify what conditions, other than the rise of the market, made it possible for the 'so-called primitive accumulation' to take place and succeed (in some places, while it failed in others)." ¹³	Defines the result of primitive accumulation precisely as the dissolution of pre-capitalist reproduction and compulsion to exchange; identifies endogenous transformation of property relations as the missing process ¹⁴	F4, R1.F4, R2.F3

COMMITMENT	FIRST ESTABLISHED IN (TEXT, YEAR)	ANCHOR IN PRE-FOCAL TEXT	WHAT THE FOCAL TEXT ADDS OR CHANGES	FINDING
The focal text's genuine addition: a Marxological genealogy explaining why these commitments require rejecting one Marxism, not merely rival social theories	Focal text (1985) — no pre-1985 precedent for this argumentative form	"The place of relatively autonomous, 'discontinuous' processes of class development and class conflict was not made clear; or it appeared to be strictly subordinated to—the necessary effect of—the growth of trade." ¹⁵	Identifies an incompatible early Smithian model inside Marx itself; turns the anti-commercialization thesis into an internal reconstruction of two historical materialisms, explaining why the error recurs ¹⁶	F4, F27, R4.F1

Each of the four positive causal commitments appears verbatim in a document dated 1972–78; the focal text's only architecturally new element is the internal Marxological genealogy that explains their necessity.

The founding claim — that market opportunities have socially variable effects and cannot be assumed to operate automatically — is already stated in 1972 by Brenner's study of London merchant groups. The causal priority of class and property relations over demographic and commercial pressures is the explicit thesis of the 1976 agrarian class structure essay. The distinction between exchange and capitalist compulsion is fully articulated in the 1977 Origins article. The demand for a specified account of class formation and primitive accumulation — beyond the rise of the market — is the burden of the 1978 Reply to Sweezy.

The 1977 text is particularly direct. Brenner there writes that trade 'cannot determine the transformation of class relations of production,'¹² making the anti-commercialization thesis a matter of record eight years before the focal article. The 1978 Reply goes further by naming the lacuna: Sweezy never explained what conditions, beyond the market, allowed primitive accumulation to succeed in some places and fail in others. The focal text answers that question by defining what primitive accumulation must accomplish — the dissolution of pre-capitalist reproduction — but it inherits the question from 1978, not from 1985.

What the focal text does add is architectural. It explains why these four commitments require breaking not just with Wallerstein or Sweezy but with one Marxian tradition.⁹ By locating the error inside early Marx — rather than only in twentieth-century neo-Smithian variants — it supplies the genealogical warrant for the rejection. That move converts a set of dispersed polemical and comparative commitments into a single internal critique: the anti-commercialization thesis becomes intelligible as a choice between two incompatible historical materialisms rather than a preference for one social theory over another.

The bottom row of Table 1 captures this: the focal text's only architecturally new element is the Marxological genealogy that explains the recurrence of the error. The four positive causal commitments

are inherited; the form of argument is new. This is why the right term for the focal text's retrospective position is culmination rather than origin — it explains the necessity of commitments that were already doing work, without having invented them.

4 Seeds and Development: What the Focal Text Started

If the focal text's substantive commitments are inherited, the question becomes what it plants for later work. Table 2 maps the seeds: elements of the focal article's causal grammar that became operative across later texts, and elements that did not travel.

Table 2. Seeds planted by the focal text, their first later development, and their fate across the oeuvre

SEED / ELEMENT	FOCAL ANCHOR	FIRST DEVELOPED IN (POST-1985)	HOW DEVELOPED	FATE: GENERALIZED / SELECTIVE / ABANDONED
Property relations as antecedent structures of societal reproduction	"Its master principle is the mode of production, conceived as a system of social Property relations which make possible, and thereby structure, Societal reproduction" ¹	The Social Basis of Economic Development (1986), then Property and Progress (2007)	1986 converts the focal contrast into a formal sequence: property relations → rules for reproduction → long-term developmental patterns; 2007 systematizes the full causal chain across transition, comparative development, and crisis ¹⁷	Generalized
Compulsory market dependence as the distinguishing mark of capitalism (not exchange alone)	"everyone must buy most of what they need. In order to buy what they need, they must not only have something they} can sell, but actually be able to sell it \"on the market\"" ¹⁸	The Social Basis of Economic Development (1986); extended to crisis theory by Competition and Class (1999)	1986 formalizes the compulsion: 'they specialize because they must exchange'; crisis theory extends the same compulsion to explain why cost-cutting under competition is structurally unavoidable for capitalist enterprises ¹⁹	Generalized
The unresolved transition problem: how feudal actors pursuing feudal reproduction unintentionally transform feudal property relations	"To confront this problem - which Marx barely posed and never solved - will require in my opinion, a deepened appreciation of the role of class formation and class struggle" ²⁰	The Low Countries in the Transition to Capitalism (2001)	Answers the focal open question historically: capitalist social-property relations had to result from feudal actors carrying out feudal rules for reproduction; the unintended-consequences formula becomes a positive historical proposition ²¹	Generalized

SEED / ELEMENT	FOCAL ANCHOR	FIRST DEVELOPED IN (POST-1985)	HOW DEVELOPED	FATE: GENERALIZED / SELECTIVE / ABANDONED
Prisoners-dilemma grammar: individually necessary reproductive action produces collectively self-undermining aggregate outcomes	"In providing reasons to foresake the invisible hand, Marx obliges himself to confront a whole series of prisoners dilemmas." ²²	The Economics of Global Turbulence (1998)	Transfers the grammar from the transition problem to capitalist crisis: firms' individually compelled remedies for reduced profitability reproduce reduced profitability at the aggregate level; the 2025 text restates the same paradox for secular stagnation ²³	Generalized (transferred domain)
Early-Marx individuation genealogy, family atomism, and craft–manufacture–machinofacture stage sequence	"In broadest terms, then, Marx sketches a process of individuation leading from tribal-communal property toward capitalism by way of exchange and specialization." ²⁴	Not returned to as a major explanatory object in any supplied later text	1989 resumes the two-model framework but shifts to English historical interpretation; later texts retain the critique of productive-force primacy without rebuilding the detailed genealogy of individuation or the stage sequence ²⁵	Abandoned (within supplied corpus)

The positive causal grammar — property relations → reproductive rules → aggregate outcomes with unintended consequences — generalizes across transition, Soviet, and crisis contexts, while the focal text's detailed Marxological apparatus (individuation, family atomism, stage sequence) does not recur as an explanatory object.

The pattern is asymmetric: the portable framework generalizes, the detailed Marxological apparatus narrows.

The central generalization is the causal chain itself. The 1986 Social Basis of Economic Development is the first subsequent text to formalize it — property relations generate rules of reproduction, which in turn produce long-term developmental patterns.²⁶ That sequence is stated as a formal arrow diagram in the 1986 essay, condensing what the focal article had argued at length through Marx's texts. The 2007 Property and Progress then systematizes the full chain across transition, comparative development, and crisis, making it the mature theoretical synthesis that the focal article had only sketched.

The transition problem — how feudal actors pursuing feudal reproduction unintentionally transform feudal property relations — is the focal text's most consequential open question. The 2001 Low Countries essay is the first text to answer it positively and historically: ²¹ capitalist social-property relations emerged specifically because feudal actors were following feudal rules, not because they were reaching toward capitalism. What was a 'prisoners dilemma' posed at the level of theory in 1985 becomes a demonstrated historical proposition by 2001.

The prisoners-dilemma grammar itself travels further than transition history. The focal text uses it to describe the problem Marx faces when he abandons Smith's invisible hand: actors trying to preserve their conditions of reproduction can collectively undermine them. ²² The 1998 Economics of Global Turbulence transfers exactly this grammar to capitalist crisis: firms whose individually compelled cost-cutting remedies reproduce reduced profitability at the aggregate level are caught in the same structural paradox, only now inside an established capitalism rather than at its origin.

The element that does not travel is the detailed genealogy of early Marxian individuation — the sequence from tribal-communal property through exchange and specialization to private property, the derivation of capitalism through craft, manufacture, and machinofacture stages, and the treatment of the family as the ultimate social atom of mechanical individualism. The 1989 Bourgeois Revolution essay resumes the two-model framework but shifts immediately to English historical interpretation; later texts retain the critique of productive-force primacy while abandoning this specific scaffolding. A second commissioned exhibit to track this Marxological apparatus through later texts could not be built from the available profiles, so the finding rests on the absence of those genealogical elements from every post-1985 supplied text. What the focal article seeds, in short, is its causal grammar — not its textual architecture.

5 Deepening, Not Rupture: The 1985 Text as a Hinge Between Formation and Codification

The verdict on epistemic rupture depends on which dimension of the oeuvre is measured. Table 3 classifies the full range of potential changes across the 1985 focal boundary.

Table 3. Dimensions of potential change across the focal boundary, classified by type

DIMENSION	BEFORE 1985	AT OR AFTER FOCAL TEXT	TYPE OF CHANGE	RUPTURE EVIDENCE?
Immediate method / evidentiary route	Comparative agrarian history and external polemic against Wallerstein, Sweezy, and demographic models ²⁷	Internal Marxological reconstruction of two incompatible historical materialisms; historical comparison resumes from 1986 onward ¹⁶	Methodological — consistent with deepening	No: a change in evidentiary route does not alter the causal ontology
Principal interlocutors	Wallerstein, Sweezy, Dobb, Postan, Hilton, Pirenne — external rival theories and empirical historians ¹²	Early Marx (German Ideology, Poverty of Philosophy, Manifesto) and Adam Smith as genealogical source; Wallerstein and Sweezy repositioned as later adopters of an early-Marxian Smithian strategy ²⁸	Change in interlocutors — consistent with deepening	No: the same causal objection (trade cannot transform property relations) is now located inside Marx rather than only against rival theorists
Causal ontology: property relations as antecedent, mediating structures	"Different class structures, specifically 'property relations' or 'surplus extraction relations', once established, tend to impose rather strict limits and possibilities, indeed rather specific long-term patterns, on a society's economic development." ²⁹	"social-property systems, once established, tend to set strict limits and impose certain overall patterns upon the course of economic evolution." ³⁰	Vocabulary sharpening (class structure → social-property relations structuring reproduction) — continuous in substance	No: the causal claim is identical on both sides of 1985; the reformulation is terminological and organizational, not ontological
Causal ontology: market dependence not exchange as capitalist compulsion	"Only where labour power is a commodity—and which was therefore called by Marx 'generalized commodity production'—is there the necessity of producing at the 'socially necessary' labour time in order to survive." ¹¹	"My point of departure is the anarchy of capitalist production and, in particular, the competitive pressure on capitalist enterprises to cut costs as the condition	Continuous — consistent with deepening	No: market dependence as the basis of compulsory competition persists without interruption before and after 1985

DIMENSION	BEFORE 1985	AT OR AFTER FOCAL TEXT	TYPE OF CHANGE	RUPTURE EVIDENCE?
		for their very survival." ³¹		
Crisis mechanism: class struggle vs. inter-capitalist competition as immediate causal driver	"It is these contrasting outcomes of processes of class conflict—dependent in turn on contrasting evolutions of class society and disparate balances of class forces at different points in time—which are at the heart of the original transition from feudalism to capitalism." ³²	"It is the logic of competition, not class struggle, that rules the deeper rhythms of growth or recession." ²³	Real later tension — but located at 1998, not at 1985	No rupture at 1985: this shift emerges in the 1998 crisis synthesis more than a decade after the focal text; it does not originate at the focal boundary
Political capitalism: asset-based circuit alongside productive accumulation	Focal text centers capitalist compulsion on competitive productive reproduction: "To insure continued ability to produce for exchange and to compete, everyone has a motivation to adopt the most advanced technique." ³³	"No longer does the classical capitalist circuit of capital M–C–M' prevail nearly universally... There has emerged alongside it a new circuit of capital whereby a surplus is realized through the investment of money in assets—viz. M–A–M'." ³⁴	Later reorientation — located at 2022–25, not at 1985	No rupture at 1985: political capitalism is a late conceptual addition that does not originate at the focal text; the 2025 text presents it as emerging alongside, not replacing, productive capitalism

Changes in method and interlocutors cluster at 1985, while changes in causal ontology are either absent or located at later dates (1998 for competition-over-class-struggle; 2022–25 for political capitalism).

Read down the final column, the pattern is consistent: no dimension that could plausibly count as the causal ontology changes at 1985. The changes that do occur at the focal boundary are changes in method and interlocutors — real changes, but not the kind that alter what the oeuvre claims about how history works.

The causal ontology on both sides of the boundary is identical. Before 1985, Brenner's 1972 merchant-history essay already argues that commercial opportunities have effects only through socially constituted actors: ⁸ the response to opportunity varies with the social, political, and economic character of the mercantile group. After 1985, the same principle is restated in the vocabulary of social-property systems: ³⁰ once established, they set strict limits and impose overall patterns on economic evolution. The

proposition is the same; only the vocabulary has been sharpened from 'class structure' to 'social-property relations structuring reproduction.'

What changes at 1985 is the evidentiary route. Before, Brenner makes his case by comparing agrarian outcomes across England, France, and eastern Europe, and by critiquing Wallerstein and Sweezy from outside. In 1985, he makes the same case by reading early against later Marx. That is a genuine methodological change — and one the focal text acknowledges explicitly by calling its own procedure based on 'hindsight,' using later Marxian concepts to interrogate the earlier works. But a change in evidentiary route is not a change in causal ontology.

Two real shifts are registered in Table 3, but neither is located at 1985. The first concerns the immediate causal driver of capitalist crisis. Brenner's pre-1985 transition writings put class conflict at the center; the 1998 *Economics of Global Turbulence* then gives priority to inter-capitalist competition: ²³ it is the logic of competition, not class struggle, that rules the deeper rhythms of growth or recession. That is a genuine later tension, emerging more than a decade after the focal text. The second concerns political capitalism — the M–A–M' asset circuit emerging alongside productive accumulation — which is a conceptual development of the 2022–25 texts, not of 1985. Both of these are post-focal developments, not changes at the focal boundary.

The defensible periodization is therefore formation (1972–84) versus codification and extension (1985–2025), with 1985 as the hinge where an established class-relational programme becomes self-conscious about its Marxological alternatives. The hinge is real: the method changes, the interlocutors change, the vocabulary sharpens. But the underlying causal claim — that historically specific property relations mediate market effects, that transition requires transformed social relations not trade, that capitalist compulsion derives from market dependence not exchange — persists unchanged on both sides of the divide.

6 Reading Route and Unresolved Questions: What Would Change This Verdict

A researcher approaching Brenner's oeuvre through the 1985 focal text should not read it first. Its argument presupposes the anti-commercialization thesis and the class-relational account of divergent agrarian outcomes; without those, the Marxological reconstruction floats free of its evidential base. The recommended sequence begins with the 1977 *Origins of Capitalist Development* — the text that establishes, in the clearest pre-focal formulation, that trade cannot transform class relations of production and that capitalist compulsion requires market dependence, not exchange alone. Second comes the 1976 *Agrarian Class Structure* essay, which supplies the comparative historical foundation: class power mediates demographic and commercial pressures into divergent developmental outcomes. With those two in hand, the focal text's demolition of early Marx reads as the theoretical self-clarification of an already-existing research programme rather than its inauguration.

From the focal text, the most direct sequel is the 1989 *Bourgeois Revolution and Transition to Capitalism* essay, which is the supplied corpus's clearest whole-argument uptake of the two-model distinction, applying it to the English Revolution and the 'landlord shell' account of agrarian capitalism. Fourth in the sequence is the 2001 *Low Countries* essay, which answers the focal text's most consequential open question: ³⁵ it was the problem of accounting for the transformation of pre-capitalist property relations into capitalist ones via the action of pre-capitalist society itself — and the 2001 text supplies that account historically, converting the programmatic demand into a positive proposition about unintended consequences. The sequence closes with the 2007 *Property and Progress*, which formalizes the complete causal chain ²⁶ from historically specific social-property relations to individual rules for reproduction to aggregate developmental patterns to society-wide forms of crisis.

Three archival tests could revise the 'deepening not rupture' verdict, and a researcher should treat them as open. The first and highest-priority test is locating the continuation the focal article announces: ⁷ 'This article is Part I of a longer work to be published separately.' If that longer work exists and contains a detailed positive reconstruction of the second Marxian model, the focal text's current status as an incomplete hinge may need to be revised upward — it may represent not a programmatic sketch but the first half of a sustained symmetrical argument. Without the continuation, the positive model remains under-specified relative to the negative critique, and that asymmetry matters for assessing what the 1985 article actually achieved.

The second test is compositional. The focal text, the 1985 *Agrarian Roots of European Capitalism*, and the 1986 *Social Basis of Economic Development* share overlapping arguments in the same narrow window. Because they are same-year or consecutive-year publications, the packet cannot establish their composition sequence from publication dates alone. Drafts, correspondence, or editorial records would be needed to determine whether the focal text generated the 'rules for reproduction' formulation or whether the three emerged in parallel from a programme already underway — a distinction that directly affects the claim that the focal text seeded the later theoretical vocabulary.

The third test requires reading two bodies of work absent from the supplied collection: the 1978 'Dobb on the Transition' essay and the 1996–97 transition studies cited in later profiles. If those texts already deploy 'rules for reproduction' or formulate the unintended-consequences mechanism, the dating of certain conceptual innovations must be moved earlier, and the focal text's role as the point of their first articulation would need qualification. Until those documents are read, the verdict — formation before 1985, codification and extension after it, deepening not rupture at the boundary — stands on the available evidence, but it stands provisionally.

7 What this means

First archival test — highest priority: locate the continuation the focal article announces ('This article is Part I of a longer work to be published separately'). If that text exists and contains a symmetrical

positive reconstruction of Marx's second model, the focal article's current assessment as an incomplete hinge with an under-specified positive alternative must be revised upward; without it, the asymmetry between the demolition of the first model and the programmatic sketch of the second stands as a permanent limitation on what the 1985 article achieved, not a gap to be filled by inference.

Second archival test: establish the composition sequence of the focal text, the 1985 Agrarian Roots of European Capitalism, and the 1986 Social Basis of Economic Development through drafts, correspondence, or editorial records. Publication dates are insufficient to determine whether the focal text generated the 'rules for reproduction' formulation that the 1986 essay formalizes, or whether all three emerged in parallel from a programme already underway; the answer directly affects the claim that the focal text seeded the later theoretical vocabulary rather than merely co-expressed it.

Third archival test: read the two bodies of work absent from the supplied collection — the 1978 'Dobb on the Transition' essay and the 1996–97 transition studies cited in later profiles. If either already deploys 'rules for reproduction' or articulates the unintended-consequences mechanism for pre-capitalist actors, the dating of those innovations attributed here to 1985–86 must be moved earlier and the focal text's role as the point of first articulation would require qualification. Until those three tests are run, the recommended reading route for a researcher is: 1977 Origins → 1976 Agrarian Class Structure → 1985 focal text → 1989 Bourgeois Revolution → 2001 Low Countries → 2007 Property and Progress, in that order, because the focal text presupposes the anti-commercialization thesis and its Marxological reconstruction floats free of its evidential base without the prior comparative-historical foundation.

Anchors

Every numbered anchor is a verbatim passage from a source document, verified mechanically against the text.

1. **(1985) — (1985) — Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism:** “Its master principle is the mode of production, conceived as a system of social Property relations which make possible, and thereby structure, Societal reproduction”
2. **(1985) — (1985) — Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism:** “It must, at every strategic juncture, assume the transition in order to explain the transition.”
3. **(1985) — (1985) — Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism:** “the outcomes of these class struggles cannot affect the supercession of one stage by the next; for they are themselves predetermined by the development of the productive forces.”
4. **(1985) — (1985) — Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism:** “The first of these models was presented in Marx's earlier works from the German Ideology (1845-6) to the Poverty of Philosophy (1847), and was magistrally sketched in the Communist Manifesto (1848).”
5. **(1985) — (1985) — Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism:** “In the Grundrisse, Marx defines property relations as the relations of the direct producers to the means of production and to one another which allow for their continuing reproduction as they were.”

6. (1985) — (1985) — **Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism**: “Specifically, it mirrors rather closely Adam Smith's classic account of the © transition from feudalism to capitalism in the Wealth of Nations”
7. (1985) — (1985) — **Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism**: “This article is Part I of a longer work to be published separately.”
8. (1972) — (1972) — **The Social Basis of English Commercial Expansion, 1550–1650 [profile]**: “The reaction to commercial opportunity (or cost), if indeed there is one, will tend to vary with the social, political, and economic character of the mercantile group.”
9. (1985) — (1985) — **Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism**: “property relations form the precondition and basis for production, they are not the product of production.”
10. (1976) — (1976) — **Agrarian Class Structure and Economic Development in Pre-Industrial Europe [profile]**: “It is the structure of class relations, of class power, which will determine the manner and degree to which particular demographic and commercial changes will affect long-run trends in the distributio”
11. (1977) — (1977) — **The Origins of Capitalist Development: A Critique of Neo-Smithian Marxism [profile]**: “Only where labour power is a commodity—and which was therefore called by Marx 'generalized commodity production'—is there the necessity of producing at the 'socially necessary' labour time in order to”
12. (1977) — (1977) — **The Origins of Capitalist Development: A Critique of Neo-Smithian Marxism [profile]**: “The rise of trade is not at the origin of a dynamic of development because trade cannot determine the transformation of class relations of production.”
13. (1978) — (1978) — **Reply to Sweezy [profile]**: “Nor did Sweezy specify what conditions, other than the rise of the market, made it possible for the 'so-called primitive accumulation' to take place and succeed (in some places, while it failed in oth”
14. (1985) — (1985) — **Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism**: “Yet, Marx also says that the condition for the rise of capitalism is precisely the dissolution of these pre-capitalist property forms”
15. (1978) — (1978) — **Reply to Sweezy [profile]**: “The place of relatively autonomous, 'discontinuous' processes of class development and class conflict was not made clear; or it appeared to be strictly subordinated to—the necessary effect of—the grow”
16. (1985) — (1985) — **Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism**: “There are two Marxian models of the transition from feudalism to capitalism. These are often confused and run_ together. Nevertheless, they are entirely incompatible: they represent two fundamentally”
17. (2007) — (2007) — **Property and Progress: Where Adam Smith Went Wrong [profile]**: “The causal chain runs from historically specific, politically reproduced social property relations to individual rules for reproduction to aggregate developmental patterns to society-wide forms of cri”
18. (1985) — (1985) — **Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism**: “everyone must buy most of what they need. In order to buy what they need, they must not only have something”
19. (1986) — (1986) — **The social basis of economic development [profile]**: “It is not that people exchange so as to specialize, or specialize so as to exchange; they specialize because they must exchange.”
20. (1985) — (1985) — **Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism**: “To confront this probleb - which Marx barely posed and never solved - will require in my opinion, a deepened appreciation of the role of clas: formation and class struggle”
21. (2001) — (2001) — **The Low Countries in the Transition to Capitalism [profile]**: “the emergence of capitalist social-property relations had to result from attempts by feudal individual actors to carry out feudal rules for reproduction”
22. (1985) — (1985) — **Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism**: “In providing reasons to foresake the invisible hand, Marx obliges himself to confront a whole series of prisoners dilemmas.”

23. (1998) — (1998) — **The Economics of Global Turbulence (Special Issue) [profile]**: “It is the logic of competition, not class struggle, that rules the deeper rhythms of growth or recession.”
24. (1985) — (1985) — **Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism**: “In broadest terms, then, Marx sketches a process of individuation leading from tribal-communal property toward capitalism by way of exchange and specialization.”
25. (1985) — (1985) — **Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism**: “A premise of all social-historical development, it is the ultimate social atom.”
26. (1986) — (1986) — **The social basis of economic development [profile]**: “form of property relations—rules for reproduction of the individual economic actors>long-term pattern of economic development/non-development.”
27. (1976) — (1976) — **Agrarian Class Structure and Economic Development in Pre-Industrial Europe [profile]**: “The breakthrough from “traditional economy” to relatively self-sustaining economic development was predicated upon the emergence of a specific set of class relations in the countryside, that is capita”
28. (1985) — (1985) — **Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism**: “any number of Marxists, from Engels to Sweezy to Wallerstein, would “follow” the master in adopting essentially Smithian strategies to explain large-scale historical transformations”
29. (1976) — (1976) — **Agrarian Class Structure and Economic Development in Pre-Industrial Europe [profile]**: “Different class structures, specifically “property relations” or “surplus extraction relations”, once established, tend to impose rather strict limits and possibilities, indeed rather specific long-te”
30. (1985) — (1985) — **The Agrarian Roots of European Capitalism [profile]**: “social-property systems, once established, tend to set strict limits and impose certain overall patterns upon the course of economic evolution.”
31. (1999) — (1999) — **Competition and Class: A Reply to Foster and McNally [profile]**: “My point of departure is the anarchy of capitalist production and, in particular, the competitive pressure on capitalist enterprises to cut costs as the condition for their very survival.”
32. (1977) — (1977) — **The Origins of Capitalist Development: A Critique of Neo-Smithian Marxism [profile]**: “It is these contrasting outcomes of processes of class conflict—dependent in turn on contrasting evolutions of class society and disparate balances of class forces at different points in time—which ar”
33. (1985) — (1985) — **Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism**: “To insure continued ability to produce for”
34. (2025) — (2025) — **The Long Downturn and Its Political Results: A Reply to Critics [profile]**: “No longer does the classical capitalist circuit of capital M–C–M' prevail nearly universally... There has emerged alongside it a new circuit of capital whereby a surplus is realized through the invest”
35. (1989) — (1989) — **Bourgeois revolution and transition to capitalism [profile]**: “It was the problem of accounting for the transformation of pre-capitalist property relations into capitalist property relations via the action of pre-capitalist society itself.”

How this was made

This dossier was produced by a recorded, multi-step method. Each step reads the previous step's output; nothing here comes from a single prompt.

Source documents

1. [focal:em:CBT7B8CL] (1985) — (1985) — Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism (88,691 chars)

2. [before:em:VAYFENVQ] (1972) — (1972) — The Social Basis of English Commercial Expansion, 1550–1650 [profile] (18,208 chars)
3. [before:em:27CQX9UR] (1976) — (1976) — Agrarian Class Structure and Economic Development in Pre-Industrial Europe [profile] (18,484 chars)
4. [before:em:HZHLWZ2R] (1977) — (1977) — The Origins of Capitalist Development: A Critique of Neo-Smithian Marxism [profile] (19,478 chars)
5. [before:em:9VI9FSBK] (1978) — (1978) — Reply to Sweezy [profile] (9,871 chars)
6. [before:em:BHRWPT7F] (1980) — (1980) — A New Social Democracy? [profile] (13,669 chars)
7. [before:em:TGWH6ZPU] (1981) — (1981) — Reagan, the Right and the Working Class [profile] (9,492 chars)
8. [before:em:6U35NCDN] (1981) — (1981) — The Right Wing and the Working Class: A Response [profile] (8,934 chars)
9. [before:em:Q6WXW5PM] (1983) — (1983) — Again on Reform or Revolution in Poland, a response to Theoretical Review [profile] (9,596 chars)
10. [before:em:SS9844LV] (1984) — (1984) — Can the Left Use the Democratic Party? [profile] (9,802 chars)
11. [after:em:9RJCZ6KQ] (1985) — (1985) — The Agrarian Roots of European Capitalism [profile] (16,567 chars)
12. [after:em:HYA4MA32] (1985) — (1985) — The Paradox of Social Democracy: The American Case [profile] (18,114 chars)
13. [after:em:3JSL5XP4] (1986) — (1986) — Austerity & Interventionism: Political Effects of Economic Decline (Part 2) [profile] (10,019 chars)
14. [after:em:S52G8SSP] (1986) — (1986) — The Deep Roots of U.S. Economic Decline [profile] (15,385 chars)
15. [after:em:KUF7CP3S] (1986) — (1986) — The Elections and the Left [profile] (12,149 chars)
16. [after:em:XTTG43Z5] (1986) — (1986) — The social basis of economic development [profile] (11,066 chars)
17. [after:em:3PBW7WA9] (1988) — (1988) — Notes on the Crash and Crisis [profile] (8,110 chars)
18. [after:em:LJFTS6KY] (1989) — (1989) — Bourgeois revolution and transition to capitalism [profile] (15,877 chars)
19. [after:em:2VPKTHSN] (1989) — (1989) — Untitled contribution on the class nature of the Soviet Union [profile] (7,275 chars)
20. [after:em:IMRP3JQ7] (1991) — (1991) — Soviet Union-Eastern Europe, Part II: Nature of the Transition [profile] (10,020 chars)
21. [after:em:D28G2RWK] (1991) — (1991) — The Regulation Approach: Theory and History [profile] (20,248 chars)
22. [after:em:GR426WC5] (1991) — (1991) — The Soviet Union & Eastern Europe, Part I [profile] (7,135 chars)
23. [after:em:K67KNHJC] (1991) — (1991) — Why is the United States at War with Iraq? [profile] (12,307 chars)
24. [after:em:8X5QYXZG] (1993) — (1993) — Failing to Bring the State Back In [profile] (9,002 chars)
25. [after:em:ZH86SA7Z] (1993) — (1993) — Merchants and Revolution: Commercial Change, Political Conflict, and London's Overseas Traders, 1550–1653 [profile] (20,257 chars)
26. [after:em:ZJHK954P] (1993) — (1993) — The Problem of Reformism [profile] (10,349 chars)
27. [after:em:U42IYG2I] (1995) — (1995) — Clinton's Failure & the Politics of U.S. Decline [profile] (8,071 chars)
28. [after:em:BD8RCVGB] (1998) — (1998) — A View of the Teamster Tragedy [profile] (9,511 chars)

29. [after:em:ZFPK9NTQ] (1998) — (1998) — The Economics of Global Turbulence (Special Issue) [profile] (19,068 chars)
30. [after:em:L7CX4T2I] (1998) — (1998) — The Looming Crisis of World Capitalism [profile] (9,842 chars)
31. [after:em:4DYCDX3A] (1999) — (1999) — Competition and Class: A Reply to Foster and McNally [profile] (14,411 chars)
32. [after:em:A5KQX6MT] (1999) — (1999) — Reply to Critics [profile] (16,738 chars)
33. [after:em:T33SBUEY] (2000) — (2000) — The Boom and the Bubble [profile] (12,829 chars)
34. [after:em:ATQRKQMC] (2001) — (2001) — The Low Countries in the Transition to Capitalism [profile] (19,947 chars)
35. [after:em:TAGBBUU9] (2001) — (2001) — The world economy at the turn of the millennium toward boom or crisis? [profile] (15,438 chars)
36. [after:em:F4ET2EQE] (2002) — (2002) — An Economy of Two, Three Many Enrons [profile] (9,185 chars)
37. [after:em:KFEA7SRZ] (2002) — (2002) — Competition and profitability: a reply to Ajit Zacharias [profile] (11,183 chars)
38. [after:em:UYQABRK] (2002) — (2002) — England's Divergence from China's Yangzi Delta: Property Relations, Microeconomics, and Patterns of Development [profile] (18,983 chars)
39. [after:em:TJJZH6J] (2002) — (2002) — The Boom, the Bubble, and the Future [profile] (7,889 chars)
40. [after:em:TP2BBTZI] (2002) — (2002) — The Economy After the Boom [profile] (7,521 chars)
41. [after:em:CB8B4RIL] (2002) — (2002) — The trajectory of the manufacturing profit rate: a reply to Duménil and Lévy [profile] (8,388 chars)
42. [after:em:FDEWCETE] (2004) — (2004) — Elections & the Democrats [profile] (9,160 chars)
43. [after:em:DXBHHXIJ] (2004) — (2004) — New Boom or New Bubble? The Trajectory of the US Economy [profile] (14,833 chars)
44. [after:em:BHSWIJKN] (2005) — (2005) — The Capitalist Economy, 1945–2000: A Reply to Konings and to Panitch and Gindin [profile] (14,080 chars)
45. [after:em:QP74AWIU] (2006) — (2006) — The Economics of Global Turbulence: The Advanced Capitalist Economies from Long Boom to Long Downturn, 1945-2005 [profile] (19,568 chars)
46. [after:em:PWVE5QPN] (2006) — (2006) — The origins of capitalism [profile] (14,435 chars)
47. [after:em:BJ4R4EPJ] (2006) — (2006) — What Is, and What Is Not, Imperialism? [profile] (12,984 chars)
48. [after:em:C3E3GHEL] (2007) — (2007) — Property and Progress: Where Adam Smith Went Wrong [profile] (17,934 chars)
49. [after:em:UFFBTFJW] (2007) — (2007) — Structure vs Conjuncture: The 2006 Elections and the Rightward Shift [profile] (14,012 chars)
50. [after:em:32EZD9WF] (2009) — (2009) — What Is Good for Goldman Sachs Is Good for America: The Origins of the Current Crisis [profile] (18,217 chars)
51. [after:em:WNQLQHP7] (2010) — (2010) — The Political Economy of the Rank-and-File Rebellion [profile] (16,420 chars)
52. [after:em:S8AUYJ5G] (2011) — (2011) — Feudalism [profile] (13,769 chars)
53. [after:em:C8KU3XVS] (2011) — (2011) — The Pre-history of Core–Periphery [profile] (12,091 chars)
54. [after:em:7QSF5QUB] (2017) — (2017) — Introducing Catalyst [profile] (10,023 chars)

55. [after:em:NE7AJREG] (2020) — (2020) — Escalating Plunder [profile] (19,111 chars)
56. [after:em:2887CIMF] (2021) — (2021) — From theory to history: 'The European Dynamic' or feudalism to capitalism? [profile] (12,476 chars)
57. [after:em:V68V5D49] (2022) — (2022) — Seven Theses on American Politics [profile] (13,943 chars)
58. [after:em:VE9TU4JA] (2025) — (2025) — The Long Downturn and Its Political Results: A Reply to Critics [profile] (17,956 chars)

Steps

#	STEP	WHAT HAPPENED	CALLS	TOKENS IN / OUT	COST	TIME
1	reconnaissance	Read every document; profiled each (thesis, method, anchored claims) and mapped the corpus.	50	251,808 / 80,125	\$1.96	0s
2	brief	Proposed three angles with engines, cost and shape; one was chosen.	0	—	—	0s
3	plan	Turned the angle into an ordered engine sequence for the executor (depth policy enforced).	0	—	—	2s
4	analysis	Ran the engines through the executor; each phase read the previous phases' prose.	8	1,392,364 / 62,937	\$3.41	977s
5	spine	Decided what the dossier argues: one claim per section, and the table or diagram each claim needs.	2	269,326 / 9,312	\$1.15	223s
6	tables	Built the tables the spine commissioned; every row verified against verbatim anchors.	1	134,601 / 5,747	\$0.59	119s
7	figures	Drew the diagrams the spine commissioned (primitive → format → labels), rendered and checked each against its spec.	1	28,153 / 3,001	\$0.15	62s
8	compose	Wrote the sections with the exhibits on the desk, placing each at its pointer; then the summary and the close against the body; rendered HTML, PDF and Markdown.	2	126,753 / 8,336	\$0.60	189s
9	crosscheck	Read the dossier as one thing and recorded every finding with its cure; acted on the safe ones.	1	14,074 / 881	\$0.06	25s
10	receipts	Totalled every model and image call.	0	—	—	3s

Analysis engines (run through the executor)

PHASE	ENGINE	DEPTH	PASSES	MODEL	WHY
4.1	The author's agendas and turns	surface	1	openrouter/openai/gpt-5.6-sol	from the chosen deliverable's path
4.2	What the focal text cites, against the rest	surface	2	openrouter/openai/gpt-5.6-sol	from the chosen deliverable's path
4.3	The focal text as the culmination of what came before	surface	2	openrouter/openai/gpt-5.6-sol	from the chosen deliverable's path
4.4	The focal text as step one of a journey	surface	1	openrouter/openai/gpt-5.6-sol	from the chosen deliverable's path
4.5	Epistemic rupture detector	surface	1	openrouter/openai/gpt-5.6-sol	from the chosen deliverable's path
4.6	The paper's place in the oeuvre: the memo	surface	1	openrouter/openai/gpt-5.6-sol	from the chosen deliverable's path

Strategy. the path was fixed on the request; no planner call (fast lane)

The spine (what the dossier argues)

Brenner's 1985 'Marx's First Model of the Transition to Capitalism' is neither a rupture nor a mere restatement: it is a methodological hinge that converts an already-established anti-commercialization thesis into an internal genealogy of two incompatible historical materialisms, thereby codifying the causal grammar — property relations structure reproduction, which aggregates into outcomes that defeat actors' intentions — that later texts on transition, Soviet class structure, and capitalist crisis all operationalize.

- 1. Two Incompatible Historical Materialisms: The Focal Text's Central Claim** — The focal text's distinctive contribution is formal and argumentative, not substantive: it divides Marx's transition theory into two incompatible historical materialisms — an early Smithian model in which productive forces and exchange generate class and property, and a later reproduction-centered model in which social-property relations are antecedent — and shows that the early model is circular because it assumes capitalist mechanisms to explain capitalism. (diagram)
- 2. What the Focal Text Cites, Carries, and Drops: The Bibliographic Signature of a Reorientation** — The focal text assembles a uniquely concentrated Marxological dossier — centered on the German Ideology, Pre-Capitalist Economic Formations, Meek's four-stages study, and Cohen's functionalism — while dropping the agrarian-historical and world-system literature (Postan, Hilton, Wallerstein, Dobb, Pirenne) central to the 1976–78 comparative argument, and changing the argumentative role of carried citations: Marx and Smith cease to be authorities or opponents in a theory of development and become the two poles of an internal genealogy.
- 3. What the Focal Text Inherits: Culmination of the 1972–84 Transition Agenda** — The focal text inherits and codifies four substantive commitments already explicit by 1978 — that commercial opportunities have socially variable effects, that class/property relations mediate demographic and commercial pressures, that capitalist compulsion requires market dependence not exchange alone, and that transition demands an account of class formation and primitive accumulation beyond trade — and its distinctive act is not to discover these

commitments but to explain why they require breaking with one Marxian tradition rather than merely with Wallerstein or Sweezy. (table)

4. **Seeds and Development: What the Focal Text Started** — The focal text's causal grammar — property relations structure reproduction, actors' strategies can produce unintended aggregate outcomes, and market dependence distinguishes capitalism from pre-capitalist possession — became the portable framework operationalized across later transition histories, Soviet analysis, and capitalist crisis theory, while its detailed Marxological scaffolding was selectively retained. (table) (diagram)
5. **Deepening, Not Rupture: The 1985 Text as a Hinge Between Formation and Codification** — The focal text does not mark an epistemic rupture because its central causal ontology — property relations mediate market effects, transition requires transformed social relations not trade, capitalist compulsion derives from market dependence not exchange — is identical on both sides of 1985; what changes is the evidentiary route (from comparative history and external polemic to internal Marxological reconstruction) and the vocabulary (from 'class structure' to 'social-property relations structuring reproduction'), making the defensible period boundary formation (1972–84) versus codification and extension (1985–2025), not rupture at 1985. (table)
6. **Reading Route and Unresolved Questions: What Would Change This Verdict** — A researcher engaging Brenner's oeuvre through the focal text should read it fifth in a sequence beginning with the 1977 and 1976 texts that establish its premises, continuing through the 1989 and 2001 direct sequels that develop its open question, and culminating in the 2007 systematization — and should treat three archival tests as capable of revising the 'deepening not rupture' verdict: locating the announced Part II, establishing the composition sequence of the 1985–86 cluster, and reading the absent 1978 and 1996–97 transition studies.

Summary's job: States the verdict on the focal text's oeuvre position (culmination + origin + methodological reorientation, not rupture) and the two-period schema it implies, so every later section knows what it is proving · Close's job: Specifies the three archival tests that could revise the verdict (locate Part II; establish composition sequence of 1985–86 texts; read absent 1978 and 1996–97 studies) and names the reading route a researcher should follow

Cross-check findings

FINDING	WHERE	EFFECT AND CURE	AFFORDANCE	FATE
caption carries number (clamp)	section_key rupture_verdict, table_key continuities_and_changes	The table's caption carries a number; captions say what the exhibit is, numbers live in the cells and the prose. Cure: rewrite the caption without it. — cross-check: The table note carries the analytical verdict — including the specific dates 1998 and 2022–25 — that the prose of section 5 is supposed to argue. A reader who reads only the note gets the conclusion before the evidence; the note does the prose's job. Cure: strip the note to a structural description of the columns and move the interpretive content into the prose paragraph immediately following the table.	rewrite caption	executed

Totals

65 model calls · 2,217,079 input tokens · 170,339 output tokens · \$7.92 · 26.7 min wall-clock.

Walls: 16 table rows kept, 0 dropped for unverifiable anchors; 3 tables and 0 diagrams placed at their pointers in the spine's order